

RICKY CASTILLO

UX & Systems Designer

CONTACT

Burnaby, BC
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CORE SKILLS

UX Design

End-to-End Ownership, IA, Interaction Design, Visual Design

Design Systems

Tokens, Components, Governance, Handoff

Research

Observation, Feedback Synthesis, Iterative Design

Figma

Hi-Fi, Auto Layout, Components, Variables, Prototyping

Collaboration

Cross-Functional Teams, Stakeholder Presentation

Accessibility

WCAG 2, Semantic Hierarchy, Color Contrast

TOOLING

AI Tools

Claude, Figma Make, Figma AI

Adobe Suite

Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects

Technical

HTML & CSS (working knowledge)

EDUCATION

BFA, Digital Arts & Animation

Northeastern University
Boston, MA

Visual design, typography, color theory, 3D modeling, animation, motion graphics, web design, and foundational coding.

STATUS

US Citizen

Canadian Open Work Permit
Valid to 2028

No Sponsorship Required

Available Immediately
Open to Hybrid / On-Site

PROFILE

UX and systems designer with 10+ years designing tools and experiences for complex, high-stakes environments. Background spans information architecture, interaction design, design systems, and cross-functional stakeholder collaboration. Consistent track record of identifying real user needs through direct observation and feedback, then translating those insights into structured, adoptable experiences. Comfortable owning design end-to-end in small teams where decisions have direct product impact.

EXPERIENCE

Senior UX & Systems Designer

Wayfair

Jun 2023 – Sep 2024 | Boston, MA

- Built a multi-surface mapping system from scratch for Wayfair's 150,000 sq. ft. flagship retail launch in Chicago, covering 28 maps, 26 departments, and 1,200+ individual product placements across print, web, and handheld devices.
- Visited the store with a first draft already built, observed how staff actually navigated the space, and discovered every existing map faced a different direction. Locking all maps to the main entrance perspective eliminated the orientation friction entirely.
- Built the system in Adobe InDesign with department color mapping and standardized labeling, then migrated to Google Slides under launch pressure when leadership required broad accessibility.
- Prototyped a mobile app concept at my manager's request, collapsing a two-document workflow into a single interface with live inventory integration and color-coded status badges.
- Presented design rationale and iterated based on structured feedback from operations, merchandising, and technology stakeholders throughout the project.

Systems Designer

Constant Contact

May 2015 – Jan 2023 | Waltham, MA

- Identified that a 100+ page sales resource had been abandoned and self-directed a full redesign into the Sales Success Map: a structured two-tier web platform serving 200-500+ distributed users across sales and CS, formally recognized by the Chief Sales Officer.
- Spent time observing the sales floor directly and gathered ongoing feedback through conversations with reps, using those insights to shape the IA and iterate the platform after launch.
- Designed the branching information architecture around how reps actually worked during live calls rather than how content was organized internally, reducing time-to-find across the global team.
- Built and maintained design systems across multiple internal products, establishing shared components, tokens, and documentation that enabled consistent delivery at scale.

Independent UX Designer

Self-Directed

Oct 2024 – Present | Vancouver, BC

- Designing mobile-first products and interactive Figma prototypes for clients focused on usability and clean engineering handoff.
- Completed a personal UI redesign study of Edge of Eternity, restructuring a 13-item menu system to 7 items and producing a fully annotated case study covering moodboard, wireframes, high-fidelity progression, and design decisions.
- Self-directed rebuild of a past enterprise platform as a 2026 design system: full token architecture and Figma component library documenting the process live.
- Using Claude, Figma Make, and Figma AI daily to accelerate prototyping and explore AI-assisted design workflows.